

these sold for between \$500 and \$1000 apiece. At the present time, a large Turner water color will fetch anywhere up to \$25,000.

Paul Gauguin's *T e Tiai N e i Au I T e Rata*—"I Await the Letter"—is said to have once sold for less than \$50. At an auction in 1959, the painting realized more than \$300,000. In that same year, one of Braque's early works

which had once been sold at auction for \$15—was eagerly snapped up by the Queensland Art Gallery at a price of \$155,000. Also in 1959, an illuminated manuscript prepared under the direction of Matthew Paris at St.

Albans Abbey about 1250 **A.D.** sold for \$190,000—as against the \$115,000 paid for a comparable manuscript not very long before.

Such a list could be extended almost indefinitely and expanded to include practically every medium, period and school of art, from prehistoric figurines to contemporary works by abstract expressionists, action painters and representatives of the welding-torch school of sculpture—

and most certainly such things as tapestries, carpets and fine antique furniture.

I have seen the money value of the works of art I've purchased increase and even multiply several times during the years since I acquired them.

In 1938, I purchased the historic and almost legendary Ardabil Persian carpet, which had been made on the royal looms of Tabriz in 1535. Moslem Persians had considered this fabulous, 11-by-24-foot carpet so beautiful that they had said it was "too good for Christian eyes to gaze upon." But

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"Christian eyes" had often "gazed upon" the Ardabil carpet and had marveled at what they saw.

"It is worth all the pictures ever painted," the American artist James Whistler declared after seeing the Ardabil.